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URBAN RECOVERY & RECONSTRUCTION

 Housing Recovery and
Reconstruction Platform
BULLETIN
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Sattal/paati means community resting place, a common meeting point for public and community residents to jointly organize different celebrations and events. Lower part is used as resting and meeting place while upper part is used for common storage of goods for festivals, puja etc. This paati was reconstructed in Bungmati after Gorkha earthquake 2015. Photo: HRRP

Key Message from the NRA CEO



The NRA recognizes the urgent need to speed up and improve the level of support to urban housing reconstruction. Urban issues are outcomes related to finance, land ownership, municipal standards and other social factors. In addition, the partners working in urban reconstruction are very few.

To address these issues successfully and to speed up urban reconstruction, there is a need for collaborative effort from all stakeholders. Municipalities will need to play a pioneering role with clear vision for future urban form. Partners also need to increase their level of support in urban areas and come up

with new proposals. The NRA is exploring possibilities for policy-based, financial and technical interventions as feasible within its constraints.

The NRA would like to thank you all for making efforts supporting the urban recovery and reconstruction so far. I am sure we will receive further intensive support from all stakeholders in the future. Let's work together for planning and implementation of urban housing reconstruction.

HRRP fourth phase approved by the NRA Executive Committee

HRRP4 (August 2019 to December 2020) was approved by NRA Executive Committee meeting held on 26 September 2019. With the approval of HRRP4, HRRP will continue to provide its coordination services in close collaboration with the NRA, CLPIUs, DLPIUs, municipal authorities and other associated stakeholders. HRRP will prioritize its work based on the needs and priorities of Government of Nepal (GoN).

Urban Recovery and Reconstruction

The Post Disaster Recovery Framework (PDRF), published by the Government of Nepal (GoN) in May 2016, is intended to “provide a systematic, structured, and prioritized framework for implementing recovery and reconstruction” for “all of government, as well as national and international partners and other recovery stakeholders, including the affected population”.

The PDRF defines five strategic recovery objectives, the first of which is to “restore and improve disaster resilient housing, government buildings and cultural heritage, in rural areas and cities”. Under this strategic objective the PDRF outlines plans for restoring urban heritage settlements, unsafe neighbourhoods, and affected market towns, including:

- Improving access to planning and building skills
- Engaging small and medium sized businesses and cooperatives to increase investment in the revival of urban areas
- Strengthening effectiveness of municipalities and other stakeholders to plan and enforce safe and resilient rebuilding and expansion of settlements
- Advocating for comprehensive risk reduction and enforcing the safeguarding of public and open spaces for evacuation

There are elements in the PDRF sector plan that have not yet taken off but that could have a big impact on the urban housing reconstruction. These include:

- **Regeneration of heritage settlements** (including 52 in the KTM valley) – recovery of heritage settlements needs specific support and cannot take an approach focused on individual houses. Settlement planning is required accompanied by technical support for reconstruction that protects / promotes heritage building styles.
- **Community grants for local infrastructure** – housing recovery is not just about the houses. Settlement planning and recovery are equally important and providing community grants for local infrastructure could contribute hugely to this. There have been some examples where community groups in old core settlements have come together to reconstruct a ‘paati’ (resting place).

Challenges in Urban Reconstruction

The challenges in urban reconstruction was collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) through district and municipal level coordination meetings, technical meetings, orientations, trainings, and field visits. These also include, the information collected by the HRRP National Team through a technical session as well as consultations with Partner Organisations (POs) working in urban areas.

Land Issues

• Right of way

The Nepal Rural Road Standards (NRRS) specifies that right of way depends on the importance of the road and possible future development. Recommended total Right of Way (Row) and building line for different types of road are” as follows:

Road Type	Total RoW (m)	Setback distance from road land boundary / RoW to building line on either side (m)	Comments
District Road Core Network (DRCN)	20	6	10 m RoW on either side from centre line
Village Road	15	3	7.5 m RoW on either side from road centre line

In any case where the existing Right of Way is more than the above defined value, the existing available width shall be adopted as a right of way. Right of Way is generally not applied in traditional or old settlements as they were built before these standards were endorsed. But if these buildings are demolished for any reason and a new structure is rebuilt in its place then RoW must be followed, resulting in smaller plot sizes. There are many urban areas where households are reluctant to start building, or have started building and had to stop, as a result of issues with Right of Way and road expansion.

• Small Land Plots and Vertical Sub-Division

In many urban areas in the Kathmandu Valley the plot size is so small that it does not meet the minimum requirements of the building permit process and home owners are essentially stuck. The small plots are often due to the practice of vertical sub-division, where when the home is inherited by the younger generation it is divided vertically leading to increasingly smaller plot sizes over time. In some cases, the plot size may be small due to a portion of the land being sold off (land prices in the Kathmandu Valley are high and continue to increase). Where families do build on these small plots, many build with eccentric footings which are not compliant with the building code. In addition to having small plots, the houses that were or are on these plots are adjoining making the construction process even more challenging. This also increases risk during earthquakes as the buildings are not designed as adjoining and therefore may have a negative impact on neighbouring structures.

Materials & Technology

• Demolition of Vulnerable Houses & Debris Clearance

In many urban areas, particularly in the Kathmandu Valley, demolition of vulnerable houses and debris clearance has yet to be carried out. Damaged houses remain standing with support from props posing a potential threat to public safety. Narrow roads in these areas increase the difficulty of demolition and debris clearance. There are also cases where earthquake affected households believe that the longer they wait to reconstruct, the more likely it is that the government will rebuild their houses.

• Conservation of Vernacular Architecture

In the historical core areas of the Kathmandu Valley, and in other areas such as Bhimeshwor Municipality in Dolakha, there is a risk that vernacular architecture may be lost during the housing reconstruction. The 2015 Gorkha Earthquake caused significant damage to traditional houses in these areas and reconstruction has been challenging

as the National Building Code, existing building by-laws, and planning regulations do not adequately reflect conservation aspects of traditional buildings. A particular issue is that all of these are more focused on individual buildings instead of on settlements as a whole. The administrative restructuring in Nepal has also impacted the pace of reconstruction as the changes fail to understand and incorporate issues of traditional settlements. Decisions that were made by the former local authorities have been overturned by the newly established authorities. The NRA and the Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC), with support from UN Habitat, initiated formulation of an amendment to the Settlement Development, Urban Planning and Building Construction By-laws 2072 (September 2015) to better reflect the needs of heritage settlements. This amendment to the by-laws was introduced by MoUD in April 2017. The amendment covers different options that municipalities can choose for conservation of historical areas including house pooling, land pooling, and integrated settlement development. The amendment also details the process to have a settlement listed as a heritage settlement and provides guidelines for the conservation of vernacular architecture including materials and construction technologies that should be used. Another challenge is that there are not enough construction workers (carpenters, masons, etc.) available who are skilled in the techniques used in vernacular architecture.

Human Resources

Many urban areas (but not all) benefit from having had technical personnel in the municipality pre-earthquake and having to implement the building code process. Since the earthquake, the technical capacity in municipalities has been boosted by the addition of the NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff (engineers, sub-engineers, and assistant sub-engineers). However, the technical staff largely focused in the inspection process of the housing reconstruction grant and the lack of exposure and experience in building code implementation and municipal by-laws presents a challenge.

Construction Process and Systems

- **Building Permit Process**

In urban municipalities, it takes a long period of time to secure a building permit. It is thought that the time required to secure a building permit and the steps in the process that may be difficult for some homeowners, could be one of the reasons for the low reconstruction rate.

In many core settlement areas, the process for getting the building permit is effectively impossible because the land parcels are smaller than the minimum requirements.

In Urban municipalities there has been an increase in the number of homeowners adding illegal storeys beyond the number approved in their building permit. The additional storeys were mostly found in houses with 9"x9" and 9"x12" columns, as well as in houses that had not been constructed under the building permit system and were considered unsafe based on structural analysis. In response to this issue, some municipalities have been fining homeowners that have built such additional storeys, but the municipalities are flexible in the case of earthquake reconstruction and will work with the household to prepare revised building drawings. However, a full structural analysis is required to confirm the safety of the structure.

- **Coverage of Socio-Technical Assistance**

The Government of Nepal's Strategic Recovery Objective 1, under the Post Disaster Recovery Framework (PDRF), is to 'restore and improve disaster resilient housing, government buildings and cultural heritage in rural areas and cities'. The PDRF further states that to achieve this, the following is required: Owners will be provided financial assistance in tranches, supported by timely provision of technical assistance, training and facilitation, so that people can rebuild as soon as possible. It is critical that there is a uniform approach to support and implementation for

universal coverage in the 32 earthquake affected districts, including the 14 most affected districts, irrespective of funding sources. To date, coverage of socio-technical assistance has been low, especially in urban areas. The number of Partner Organisations (POs) providing socio-technical assistance is much lower in urban areas compared to rural areas. The poor coverage of socio-technical assistance in urban areas leaves households facing a complex and challenging reconstruction with likely a very large investment required from their side, without access to the information, guidance, and support they require.

HRRP has prioritized urban recovery and reconstruction as one of the major areas of focus in its fourth phase. HRRP will be working with partners working in urban areas together with the NRA to advocate to update and reform policies and to explore solutions to expedite urban reconstruction process, for further information please contact Ms. Bhubaneshwori Parajuli; techcord.national@hrrpnepal.org; National Technical Coordinator, HRRP Nepal.

Featured Technical Staff Person



Bidhya Manandhar, District Support Engineer, Kathmandu

This month's featured technical staff person is Ms. Bidhya Manandhar. She has been working as a District Support Engineer (DSE) in Kathmandu since December 2018. Prior to this, she worked as DSE in Dolakha and Kavrepalanchok. She has been a DSE since April 2016, so she brings a range of experience in post-earthquake reconstruction from three of the highly earthquake affected districts. She shared that there is a huge difference in the reconstruction scenario in these three districts she has worked due to various housing typologies, mainly in terms of structural design.

Stakeholder's Perspective on Urban Challenges

"Urban housing reconstruction, mostly traditional settlement areas, cannot be dealt with similar to the rural housing reconstruction as most of the houses have multi-ownership. Tranche support in three different installments cannot encourage beneficiaries to reconstruct within the deadlines, so solutions like provision of complete tranche support in one installment and easy access to loans need to be sought."

Ms. Meeru Shrestha, Ward Member, Dhulikhel-7

"In Khokana, a heritage settlement, the reconstruction has been a "fully owner-driven process without any partner organizations involved in providing socio technical assistance."

Mr. Rabindra Maharjan, Ward Chief, LMC-21, Lalitpur

"National Reconstruction Authority is yet to address all the traditional settlements in all earthquake affected districts. Settlement-specific reconstruction policies need to be developed in coordination with the respective municipality in order to accelerate housing reconstruction and conserve traditional settlements as well."

Mr. Sanjay Koju, Ward Chief, Dhulikhel-6

"Beneficiaries are living in a densely populated area with lack of proper urban planning. The scattered settlement at some places and high concentration at market area with little or no gap/space between two adjacent buildings is a big challenge".

Mr. Minmar Lama, Sub-engineer, Bhimeshwor Municipality-3, Dolakha

“It took me five laborers for twelve days to demolish my four-storey brick in mud mortar house spanning an area of 2 anna- 2 paisa. As the approach way is an alley, porters had to be used to transport the debris to the nearest road from where tractors were used. The total cost of demolition and debris management ranged to NPRs. 2,70,000.”

Mr. Madan Gopal Shrestha, Beneficiary, Dhulikhel-7

Highlights

- Key Message from the NRA CEO
- HRRP fourth Phase (August 2019 to December 2020) approved by NRA
- [NRA, Human Resource Section request all the DLPIU-GMaLI for the implementation of the decisions of the meeting held on 11 August 2019 \(20176/04/26\)](#)
- [NRA GESI/Livelihood Section requests partners working under GESI/Livelihood to submit project progress report](#)
- [The UK Shelter Forum 25](#)

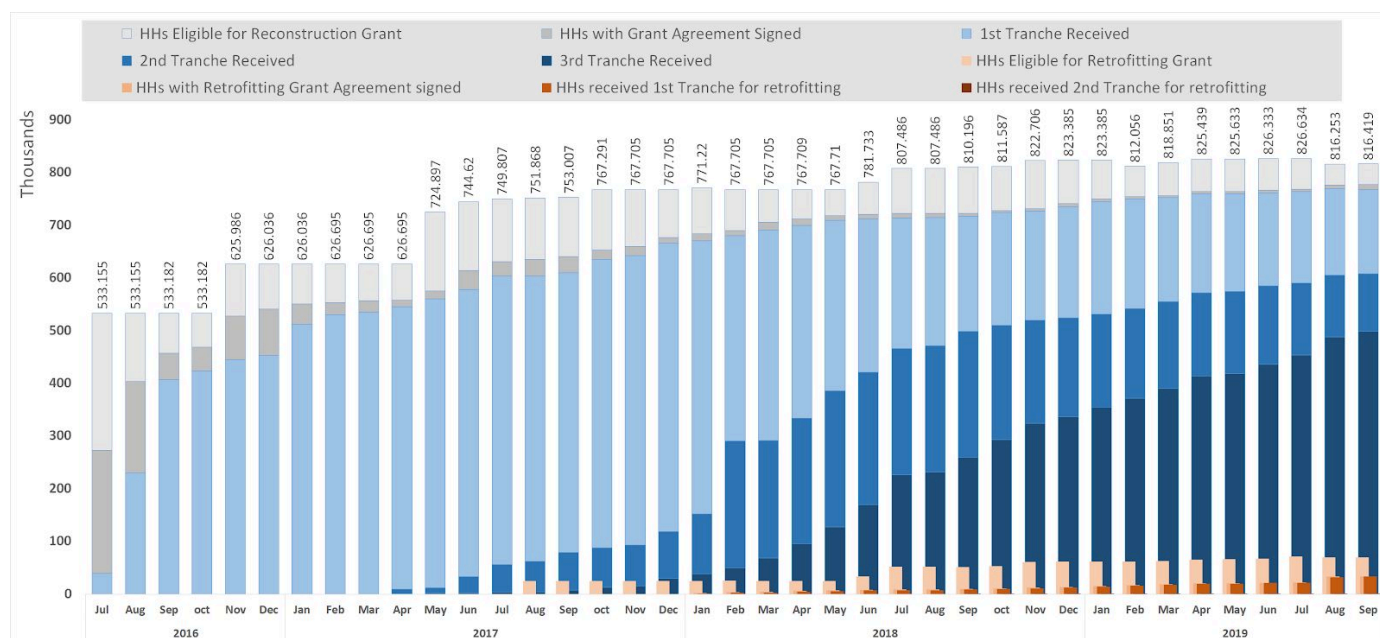
National Updates

[NRA, CLPIU GMAI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 30 September:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	15 July	26 August	30 September
Total No. Eligible HHs	826634	816253	816419
HHs Enrolled	768192	776101	776888
HHs Received 1st Tranche	763470	769105	767449
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	607597	613964	624867
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	590542	605254	607937
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	4277	4234	3590
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	479811	495452	525601
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	453354	487957	498638
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	2005	1865	1981
Houses Completed	418760	428513	464871
HHs with Completion Certificate	24361	24739	38228
Retrofit Grant	15 July	26 August	30 September
Total No. Eligible HHs	71358	69973	69581
HHs Enrolled	21984	33468	33647
HHs Received 1st Tranche	21583	31512	33155
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	45	27	28

According to the new federal structure of Nepal, there are 186 Rural Municipalities and 96 Urban municipalities in the 32 earthquake affected districts of Nepal. The progress of recovery and reconstruction at the municipal level when aggregated by their urbanization status (Urban/Rural) exhibits a stark difference. The recovery and reconstruction at the rural areas is nearing 65% completion (3rd tranche), while the same at the Urban areas is at 35%.

Status	# of Municipalities	HHs damaged	HHs Eligible	HHs Enrolled	1st Tranche	2nd Tranche	3rd Tranche
Rural	186	566,678	465,515	441,348	57.35%	63.27%	64.33%
Urban	96	479,341	359,930	328,850	42.65%	36.73%	35.67%



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMaLI CLPIU data as of 30 September 2019.

- [NRA Human Resource Section request all the DLPIU-GMaLI for the implementation of the decisions of the meeting held on 11 August 2019 \(20176/04/26\)](#): National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) has requested all the Chiefs of District Level Project Implementation Units (DLPIUs)- (Grant Management and Local Infrastructure (GMaLI) of Sankhuwasava, Dhankuta, Bhojpur, Khotang, Solukhumbu, Okhaldhunga, Ramechhap, Kavrepalanchowk, Rasuwa, Nuwakot, Lamjung, Tanahu, Baglung, Myagdi, Parbat, Syangja, Palpa, Gulmi, Arghakhanchi, Nawalparasi (Bardaghat Susta East), Makwanpur and Chiwan for the implementation of the decisions of the meeting held on 11 August 2019 (20176/04/26) presided by the NRA Chief Executive Officer (CEO) concerning work division of NRA and its implementing wings. DLPIU-GMaLI Chiefs for 23 districts except for Bhaktapur, Lalitpur, Gorkha, Dolakha, Sindhupalchowk, Sindhuli, Dhading, Kathmandu and Kaski, have been given the responsibility of performing the role of Chief of DLPIU-Building as well to resolve the problem of vacant Chief's position and carry out daily monitoring, coordination and implementation of private housing reconstruction in close coordination and communication, reporting and instruction of CLPIUs at national level. The NRA request letter to implement the decisions is available [here](#) for further reference.
- [NRA GESI/Livelihood Section requests partners working under GESI/Livelihood to submit project progress report](#): NRA GESI/Livelihood Section has requested all the partners that have signed MOU with NRA and are working under GESI/livelihood sector to submit a progress report in the NRA given outline aimed at documenting lessons learned and best practices. The request has been made following the decision of the meeting held under the chairmanship of Executive Member, Dr. Bishnu Bhandari on 26 & 29 July 2019. For more information, contact Mr. Binod Koirala, Section Officer email: bnodkoirala@gmail.com or Ms. Geeta Subedi email: subedigeeta@gmail.com
- [Social Mobilizers and Mobile Masons hiring procedure guideline -2076](#): NRA CLPIU-Building has published a guideline entitled "Social Mobilizers and Mobile Mason recruitment procedures - 2076" for the provision of transparent and effective recruitment process of social mobilisers and mobile masons aimed at providing socio-technical assistance and supporting the private housing reconstruction of earthquake affected vulnerable beneficiaries. The procedure guideline outlines processes of hiring service contract for social mobilizers and mobile mason, formation of a selection committee, the committee's role, responsibility and power, selection of candidates based on a scoring matrix, interview provision, grievance addressing mechanism, remuneration, tenure of service contract and details of application forms including terms of

reference (ToR) and sample of service contract appointment letter among others. This procedure guideline will facilitate the hiring of service contract of social mobilizer and mobile mason in earthquake affected districts.

- **[40th Social Service Day marked amidst exhibition stalls and rally program:](#)** The Social Welfare Council's (SWC) 40th Social Service day was marked on 23 September 2019 with the morning rally and the exhibition of the project activities at Bhirkutimandap in Kathmandu. More than 100 different I/NGOs and the development partners came together and expressed their solidarity and support towards GoN through their active participation. The event was inaugurated by the Vice President of Nepal, Mr. Nanda Bahadur Pun and participated by various line Ministries, key Government officials, UN, Donors, Diplomats, Ambassadors and media along with the general public
- **[Gender in Humanitarian Action Workshop, 4-5 September 2019](#)** was organized by Ministry of Home Affairs (MOHA) and UN Agencies (UNRCO, UN Women, UNDP, and UNFPA). The objective of the workshop was to enhance the capacity of different stakeholders to integrate gender into humanitarian preparedness and response through a common understanding of the humanitarian programme cycle, architecture, humanitarian programming as it relates to gender equality and women's empowerment. The session also highlighted on sharing of information, experience and good practices to strengthen accountability to the IASC Gender Policy, including the Handbook, Accountability Framework, and the Gender with Age Marker. The workshop also aimed at strengthening collaboration between government and humanitarian partners to promote collective responsibility for gender equality in humanitarian action.
- **[The UK Shelter Forum 25](#)** with the theme "Cross-sector collaboration for community resilience" is being planned for 25 October 2019. The meeting will focus on the theme but there will be opportunities for other information sharing and announcements. The agenda will be produced based on the submissions of participants, with priority given to those who adhere to the theme.
- The seventh annual **[Asia-Pacific Housing Forum](#)** was organized in Bangkok, Thailand from 16-19 September 2019 where NRA Executive Member, Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha and HRRP National Coordinator, Mr. Loren Lockwood participated from Nepal. Dr. Chandra from NRA shared the experiences on government-led owner-driven housing recovery. The Forum gathered global pioneers in housing, urban planning and sustainable development. GLTN encourages our partners to attend the forum to share their innovative work in promoting tenure security as a key driver of sustainable cities and communities.
- USAID and DAI organized a planning forum to exchange knowledge and expertise to discuss on the area of the improved disaster risk management at Local and National level. This workshop was designed to generate valuable ideas and information to contribute to the programs' three components; Stronger National level DRM system, Safer settlements: Building capacity at the Municipal Level and Strengthening disaster response and recovery. The Project Advisory Committee(PAC) for Tayar Nepal was formed and the first meeting between PAC was held during the event.

District & Municipal Updates

Interaction Workshop organized by NRA: An interaction program is being conducted by NRA, GMAI and Building for the local representatives, technical persons and related concerned stakeholders with the objective of the program to determine the reasons of delayed reconstruction. The interaction program was conducted in the presence of NRA CEO at Bhaktapur on 12 September 2019 where he encouraged local representative to expedite the reconstruction and prepare an action plan to monitor the housing reconstruction progress. Likewise, such programs are being held in 21 districts with slow reconstruction.

Training of Trainers on Earthquake Resistant Building Construction, Dhulikhel, Kavrepalanchok: Seven-day trainings were conducted from 16 - 22 September 2019 and 24 - 30 September 2019 to orient newly recruited NRA engineers. Altogether 52 engineers from Kavrepalanchok, Kathmandu, Sindhupalchowk, Sindhuli, Solukhumbu, Khotang and Okhaldhunga participated in the trainings. The event was organized by CLPIU Building with technical support from HRRP and NSET. The topics included earthquake basics, earthquake resistant design and construction philosophy, Nepal National Building Code, inspection process of reconstructed building typologies and retrofiting.

Orientation on “NRA Technical Guidelines and Policies: One day orientations were held in Lamjung (11 Sep 2019), Syangja (17 Sep 2019), Kaski (19 Sep 2019) jointly by CLPIU Building, DLPIU Building and HRRP with an objective to disseminate information on NRA technical manuals, guidelines and policies to all concerned reconstruction stakeholders. A total of 124 participants attended the orientation. The topics covered NRA guideline/policies, Correctional/Exceptional Manual, Repair and Retrofitting Manual with a new template format for inspection/categorization of buildings under retrofit, hollow concrete block manual.

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Makwanpur (30 Aug & 14 Sep) and Nuwakot (26 Sep). Municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Bhaktapur, Dolakha, Kavrepalanchok, Lalitpur, Ramechhap, Sindhuli & Sindhupalchowk, Parbat NRA. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Makwanpur**, based on the NRA notice for signing the partnership agreement and accessing the first tranche, meetings decided to coordinate with concerned stakeholders to continue and expedite the process. Likewise, regarding slow retrofit process, it was decided to conduct interaction program at each Municipality to encourage retrofitting process and to request the concerned authority to increase the retrofitting grant. Based on the data collected from CSRC/PIN, till now 973 landless households living in *ailani* (Government land) can now reconstruct houses in the place where they have been living. Finally, it was decided to coordinate with concerned authority regarding the reconstruction of Gumba which is reported as not progressing well.
- In **Nuwakot**, reconstruction is progressing well, 71% of households have received the third tranche. A retrofitting task force has been formed led by DSE to focus on retrofitting works. Most of the households under retrofit grant list were initially not interested in retrofit. However, after the demo on retrofit they have become interested in retrofitting their houses. Build Change has started model retrofit village in Belkotgadhi-5. NSET Baliyo Ghar has retrofitted nine houses in Shivapuri RM. Relocation of households to integrated settlement with support from OXFAM in eight locations is on the process of completion. CSRC is supporting to facilitate to purchase land for Landless beneficiaries.
- In **Bhaktapur**, meetings in **Ward 7 & 9, Suryabinayak Municipality (10 Sep 2019), Suryabinayak Municipality (11 Sep 2019) & Madhyapur Thimi Municipality (11 Sep 2019)** highlighted that the issues causing delay in reconstruction in Bhaktapur are that people have houses in other places (so they have not started reconstruction) and households have land ownership issues (Mohi/Talsing) such as family dispute over land ownership. One of the main issues is with landless people who have not been able to get a building permit to start reconstruction. There are few cases where families have reconstructed houses and applied for a building permit in the Municipality but have neither received the building permit nor the subsequent tranches. The ward offices decided to inform the families about the NRA grant deadline and to encourage them to start reconstruction. Further, they decided to inform the families to return the first tranche if they are not starting reconstruction, and to ask the households that have not signed the partnership agreement to submit the application stating the reasons. The ward offices also decided to collect the list of houses that were built before the deployment of technical staff, thereafter DLPIU Building would support in identifying the issues and suggest corrective measures to facilitate these households in accessing the remaining tranches.

- In **Sindhupalchok**, meetings in **Balephi Rural Municipality (4 Sep 2019)**, **Sunkoshi Rural Municipality (5 Sep 2019)** & **Indrawati Rural Municipality (16 Sep 2019)** focused on supporting the households whose houses are non-compliant and to facilitate them in accessing the remaining tranches. Concerns were raised on poor quality of completion certificates that were distributed in a few places and the delay in grievance results.
- In **Sindhuli**, **Dudhauri Rural Municipality (11 Sep 2019)**, it was reported that people who were living in *ailani* land have started reconstruction after the decision was made that those landless households living in *ailani* land could build houses on land where they have been living for generations. A task force for retrofitting has been formed at Municipal level and at District level to expedite retrofitting process. GMaLI Chief requested the ward offices to collect remaining PA forms for digitization.
- In **Ramechhap**, **Manthali Municipality (12 Sep 2019)**, **Likhu Tamakoshi Rural Municipality (22 Sep 2019)**, **Gokulganga Rural Municipality (24 Sep 2019)**, **Ward 2 Umakanda Rural Municipality (25 Sep 2019)** & **Khadadevi Rural Municipality (26 Sep 2019)**, there were concerns regarding delay in addressing the households who have appealed to be on the eligibility list for Government financial assistance. There are households in retrofit grant that have applied to be in full reconstruction grant. Few households have already dismantled their houses and started reconstruction despite the decision being made on the conversion to full reconstruction grant list. GMaLI Chief requested the ward offices to collect the details of such households and submit to GMaLI office for further process. Ward Chiefs were requested to track and encourage the households that have not signed partnership agreement and those who have taken first tranche and not started reconstruction or either remove them from the list if they are not interested in moving forward with reconstruction. In regard to the households that have not withdrawn the first tranche from the bank, ward chiefs were requested to verify if these households intend to build houses or not. GMaLI Chief also highlighted the need of door-to-door campaign to sensitize households on retrofitting.
- In **Kavrepalanchok**, **Ward 7, Dhulikhel Municipality (24 Sep 2019)** & **Ward 7, Panauti Municipality (26 Sep 2019)**, common issues causing delay in reconstruction were high cost of construction of houses in a traditional way, difficulty in demolition of houses that are attached to each other, difficulty in transportation and debris management due to narrow roads and alleys. In addition, most of the houses in these wards are inhabited by multiple families which is a major challenge in reconstruction. Lack of policy to address compact traditional settlement and lack of guidelines to retrofit traditional houses were reported as causing delay in the reconstruction process.
- In **Lalitpur**, **Ward 1, Mahankal Rural Municipality (25 Sep 2019)**, it was reported that many of the households received second tranche but have not progressed beyond plinth level delaying the reconstruction. In addition, hybrid structure houses and incomplete roof construction have hindered households in receiving third tranche. The ward office has planned to conduct a quick survey to track the reasons causing delay in reconstruction and an interaction program targeting the households that have taken second tranche but not the third tranche.
- In **Dolakha**, **Ward 9, Bhimeshwor Municipality (25 Sep 2019)**, **Ward 3, Baiteshwor Rural Municipality (26 Sep 2019)**, meetings focused on duplication of tranches, households that have taken grant amount from the Government and the partner organizations. These households will not be receiving any further tranches and might require returning the first tranche. It was reported that few households have signed the partnership agreement but have not received the first tranche. GMaLI Chief briefed on the process of receiving completion certificate and encourages households to complete reconstruction on time.
- In **Parbat**, **Phalebas Rural Municipality (25 Sep 2019)**, it was reported that many of the households have constructed new houses, but they do not have the intention to demolish the earthquake damaged houses.

Majority of the houses in the area lack corner stitches and horizontal bands thus are non-compliant. These houses were suggested correction measures to be eligible for subsequent tranches.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur and Lalitpur, Monthly Report, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019



Ward 4, Mahankal Rural Municipality, Lalitpur: two room, single storey stone in mud mortar house with an attic under construction. The homeowner has received the second tranche of the by GoN housing reconstruction grant and has applied for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Monthly Report, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019.



Ward 7, Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: a traditional brick in mud mortar house. The house is under retrofit grant list and belongs to three brothers. The home owners have visited the ward office several times to know the retrofit process to conserve the traditional architecture, but they have not been able to get any technical support. All three of them have received the first tranche of the Government retrofit grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Monthly Report, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019



Ward 4, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: single storey, one room, load bearing stone in mud mortar house with CGI roofing. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Baglung, Parbat and Myagdi, Monthly Report, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019



Ward No.9, Kushma Municipality, Parbat: single storey, three room load bearing stone in cement mortar masonry with an attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team DOLAKHA, RAMECHHAP and SINDHULI Monthly Report, 23 Aug – 27 Sep 2019



Ward 3, Bhimeshwor Municipality, Dolakha: three and a half storey, RCC building made using brick in cement mortar. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

Case Studies



Featured Technical Staff Person, Bidhya Manandhar, This month's featured technical staff person is Ms. Bidhya Manandhar. She has been working as a District Support Engineer (DSE) in Kathmandu since December 2018. Prior to this, she worked as DSE in Dolakha and Kavrepalanchok. She has been a DSE since April 2016, so she brings a range of experience in post-earthquake reconstruction from three of the highly earthquake affected districts. She shared that there is a huge difference in the reconstruction scenario in these three districts she has worked due to various housing typologies, mainly in terms of structural design.

Ms. Bidhya said majority of the newly reconstructed houses in Dolakha are load-bearing structures whereas in Kathmandu are RCC structures. However, in Kavrepalanchok, somewhat equal proportion of load-bearing and RCC structures have been reconstructed. In terms of the structural design, Dolakha being hilly area, the RCC structures are usually designed for differential foundation level for maximum of 4.5 storey whereas in Kathmandu the houses have been constructed even up to 7-8 storey especially in the core/old settlements of Kathmandu Metropolitan City. She added, she has designed nearly 100 types design of RCC frame structures, load-bearing structures and steel structures targeting the prevalent non-compliant cases. These designs implemented in Dolakha and Kavrepalanchok, however, the same designs did not work and needed redesigning in Kathmandu for structures with higher than 4.5 storey.

Ms. Bidhya feels the reconstruction is slower in Kathmandu compared to other earthquake-affected districts. She said people have added multiple storeys in the structure making the houses non-compliant and vulnerable. There are also cases where municipalities have given building permits to houses that are unsafe. She further added multiple ownership of land, adjoining houses, construction above the existing structures, and structures not being built as per the building drawing are some of the major issues in Kathmandu.

Similarly, she shared delay in retrofitting process in Kathmandu is not only due to lack of technical knowledge and skills but also the misconception between repair and retrofit. Most of the households under retrofitting grant have done minor repairing using cement slurry, epoxy instead of adopting proper retrofitting techniques. Referring to the “Repair and Retrofit” manual she suggested, if Government separates repair and retrofit, it would help people to understand the difference between repair and retrofit and encourage in adopting right techniques while rebuilding houses.

She appreciates some of the decisions taken by the Government regarding landless issues. The Government is providing flexibility for building houses in public and government land, where families have been living for many generations and has also granted the provision of multiple ownership. She hopes that the reconstruction will gradually increase in the urban areas like Kathmandu and with flexible policies Government has come up with to expedite reconstruction process. She also recommends Government to publish a written official document of such policies to be more authentic, trustworthy and to work more efficiently in reconstruction. She feels proud to be working as few female DSEs contributing to the Nepal post-earthquake reconstruction and she encourages more women to join this noble cause.

Sabina Maharjan, Beneficiary: It has been four years since Sabina Maharjan of Bungmati, ward 22, Lalitpur Metropolitan City is living in temporary shelter with her family members. She has been in the temporary shelter after their old house in Bungmati was damaged by the 2015 Gorkha earthquake. Sabina has received first tranche 50,000 NPRs from the Government but has not been able to start reconstruction due to family disputes. They have a land that also belongs to other family members, so getting the ownership of the land has been difficult thus impeding the reconstruction. Similar is the case with other families living in the temporary shelters around her. Sabina also a member of Bungmati Area Reconstruction Development Committee (BARDeC), has raised the land ownership issue with ward office but it has been difficult to resolve due to family disputes. Sabina hopes her family members become positive and settle down the issue soon so that she can start reconstruction. Although, the rubble from her old house has been cleared, she fears of missing the NRA grant deadline of accessing second tranche, which means she will have to continue living in the temporary shelter..



Ambir Raj Shakya, Ward Chief, Bungmati, Lalitpur Metropolitan City-22, Lalitpur: Mr. Shakya said the main reason for slow progress in Bungmati is that people are not aware of the building bylaws for the heritage settlement. Many households have added extra storey than specified in the building permit, to accommodate a large family size making the houses non-compliant and vulnerable. This has prevented households in accessing the government tranche. Mr. Shakya said a core heritage settlement like Bungmati should be addressed separately, not like reconstruction in other areas. He feels the technical manual and guidelines published by the government do not sufficiently address in dealing with housing designs in heritage settlements. He recommended that the NRA should come up with separate guidelines to address reconstruction issues in core heritage settlements like Bungmati and should provide sufficient technical assistance to follow building bylaws such that traditional architecture could be preserved.

Harisaran Siwakoti, Ward Chief, Bhimeshwor Municipality-3, Dolakha: Mr. Siwakoti shared that the overall reconstruction of urban areas, particularly Charikot Bazar, is slower compared to other areas in the district. Charikot is located at the top of the hill thus, with hill slope complexity, soil erosion makes it geographically

challenging for development. Mr. Siwakoti said, most of the households in Charikot are under retrofit grant list where they have constructed houses in a very congested market place, even up to 7/8 storey with 9" x 9" pillar size, whereas the NRA guideline and Municipal Building code allows up to 3.5 storey. Retrofitting of these houses also requires the removal of excess storeys as well as a high cost of technical adjustment to the building. Mr. Siwakoti said the major challenge in reconstruction in Charikot is that adjacent houses have little or no seismic gap between them. Despite geographical challenges, the timeline set by NRA for grant disbursement has made his job easier. This has supported him in convincing the households to restart reconstruction soon.



Urban recovery and reconstruction after 2015 earthquake in Dolakha, Charikot Bazar.

Left: Charikot bazar after the damage in the 2015 earthquake

Right: Urban recovery (Charikot bazar) gradually reviving in the post urban recovery as of September 2019

Media coverage and communication on Reconstruction

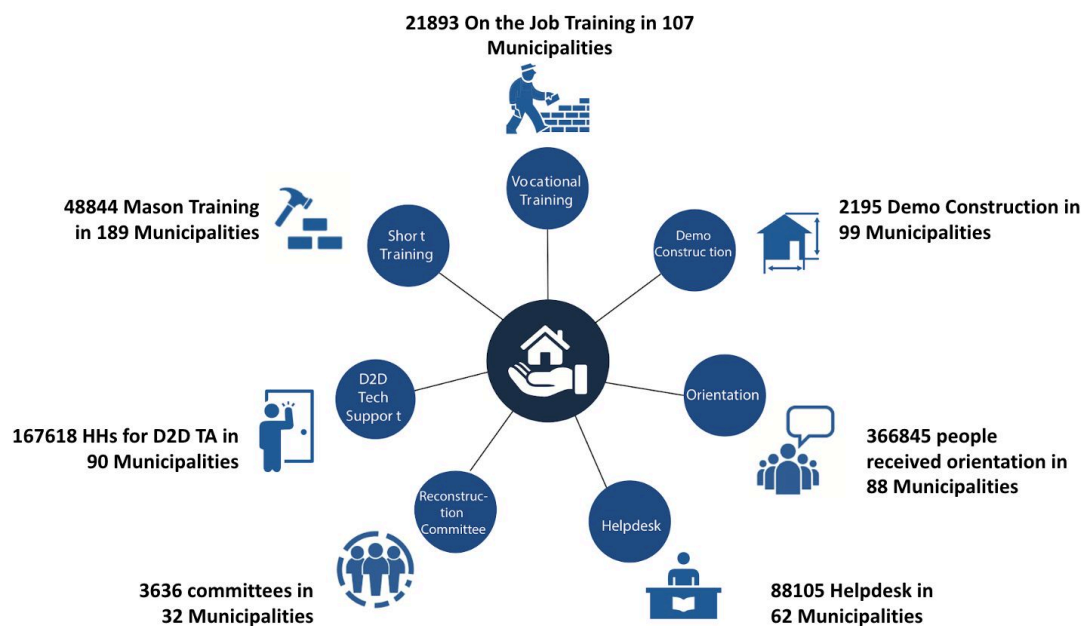
This section highlights the past media coverage and materials produced and broadcasted with the objective to inform the community on reconstruction and associated technologies.



[Sajha Sawal Episode 555](#) this episode features Mr. Sushil Gyewali, NRA CEO highlighting the reconstruction status of private housing including Dharara and Ranipokhari.

HRRP Products

NRA 5W tracks PO's activity in the earthquake affected districts. The following infographic provides a snapshot of scale of core socio-technical assistance provided by various POs on the earthquake recovery and reconstruction.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting information pack highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32 earthquake affected district at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month. Please access the links for the table provided below.

Information Pack
Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform



Gorkha

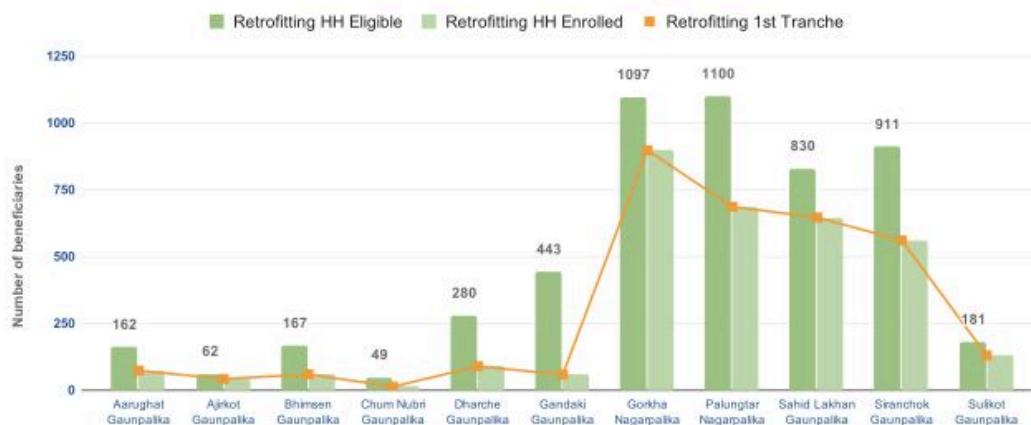
as of 29-8-2019

Name of Palika	Total HHs Surveyed	Total HHs Eligible	Total HHs Enrolled	First Tranche	Second Tranche	Third Tranche	Retrofitting HH Eligible	Retrofitting HH Enrolled	Retrofitting 1st Tranche	Retrofitting 2nd Tranche
Aarughat Gaunpalika	7188	6748	6637	6637	6346	5752	162	74	74	
Ajirkot Gaunpalika	4175	4087	3965	3965	3851	3590	62	43	43	
Bhimsen Gaunpalika	6758	6669	6586	6586	6358	5280	167	60	60	
Chum Nubri Gaunpalika	2750	2268	1970	1970	1626	1467	49	14	14	
Dharche Gaunpalika	3683	3894	3742	3742	3399	3158	280	90	90	
Gandaki Gaunpalika	6281	5176	4814	4814	4334	3414	443	59	59	
Gorkha Nagarpalika	13107	9108	8793	8793	8227	7800	1097	898	898	
Palungtar Nagarpalika	11726	8700	8187	8187	7326	6321	1100	687	687	
Sahid Lakhani Gaunpalika	7901	6227	6075	6075	5616	5076	830	647	647	
Siranchok Gaunpalika	7203	5924	5844	5844	5644	5131	911	561	561	
Sulikot Gaunpalika	7302	7021	6857	6857	6720	6495	181	131	131	

Reconstruction- Tranche Status



Reconstruction - Retrofitting Status



Partner Products

[Sustainable Tourism and Green Growth for Heritage Settlements of Kathmandu Valley](#): Urban housing construction is very complex and needs special attention to address issues like municipal building permit processes, multiple beneficiaries, land ownership and inadequate financial support, which consistently hinder the urban recovery process. Bungmati, an urban settlement area is one of the heritage settlements in the Kathmandu valley that was badly affected by Nepal earthquake 2015. About 95% of the traditional buildings within the core settlement were affected. People within the settlement are still in the process of starting the reconstruction of their houses after the fourth year due to many challenges. There are partner organizations such as UN Habitat, Center for Integrated Urban Development (CIUD, Lumanti, Sabah Nepal and Bungamati Area Reconstruction and Development Council (BARDeC) working together to support housing reconstruction in Bungmati. Lack of proper awareness among beneficiaries about building bylaws and minimum requirements have questioned the resilience capacity of the reconstructed houses. It is paramount that the capacity of local technicians in traditional building construction needs to be strengthened along with strong coordination and communication mechanism for speedy recovery of urban reconstruction.

[Meeting the Urban Challenge by ALNAP](#) provides an overview of current thinking and emerging good practice related to humanitarian action in an urban environment. It is based on the discussions held at the 27th Meeting of the Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in Humanitarian Action (ALNAP) on urban challenges and on a review of recent literature on humanitarian responses to urban crises. It considers how the nature of urban space and of urban populations influences disasters in cities; it outlines how the humanitarian community is adapting to address the challenges posed by urban areas; and it proposes some 'next steps' for the humanitarian community.

[The Urban Reconstruction in Nepal Project](#) is a research initiative to investigate aid governance, community-driven reconstruction initiatives and the rebuilding of historic urban settlements damaged by the 2015 earthquakes in the Kathmandu Valley, Nepal. This research was motivated by the lack of reconstruction progress in urban settlements one year after the earthquakes, and was carried out in conjunction with the Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform–Nepal and the Earth Observatory of Singapore. We conducted ethnographic fieldwork in five urban settlements over a period of 18 months. Our research shows that the delay in urban reconstruction was a function of the lack of a clear and well-supported policy for urban reconstruction; limited governance capacity and neglect of municipal- and ward-level officials; financial restrictions caused by the funding cap per family to rebuild their homes; and the lack of a framework to support local community-driven rebuilding initiatives.

[Formation-and-Functioning-of-Provincial-Institutions-in-the-Federal-Structure](#) is a report on the 'Formation and Functioning of Provincial Institutions in the Federal Structure. This is the fifth in the series of reports under 'Observation of post-Constitution Politics and Governance in Nepal (OPPG)' which started in January 2018. This report covers findings and analyses from all seven provinces based on DRCN's research conducted between April to July, 2019.

[The Roles of Local Governments in Disaster Management and Earthquake Reconstruction \(Aug 2019\)](#) published by Democracy Resource Center Nepal (DRCN) and supported by The Asia Foundation is a field-level scoping research on the roles of local governments in reconstruction and disaster management. The document captures the perspectives, experiences, and needs of local governments to highlight challenges and opportunities and ultimately, contribute to improved disaster preparedness and future responses at the local level.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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